



The 1940s

The outbreak of World War II drove the innovations of the time, which included the high-speed long-range bombers that changed the face of modern warfare. Jet-propelled fighters and reconnaissance aircraft were put into service for the first time by Arado and Messerschmitt in Germany, and Gloster in Britain. In the post-war period large numbers of piston-engined aircraft, such as Douglas's DC-3s and 6s, Lockheed's Constellation, and Boeing's Stratocruiser, were used for commercial transport until they were superseded by jet power.